

Council and Commissioners Workshop
December 17, 2025

Present: Beth Leisure
Max Smith
Gary Saunders
Cathy Williams
Jeff Cappa
Barry Ritter

Commissioner: Brad Dwenger
Jeff Plasterer
Aaron Roberts

Also Present: Bobbi Elsrod, Recording Secretary
Steve Higinbotham, County Administrator
Mark Hoelscher, Auditor
Simona Hiltner, Chief Deputy Auditor

President Max Smith opened the meeting at 6:00 PM and led the pledge to the flag.

Beth Leisure moved to approve the November 19, 2025 workshop minutes, Gary Saunders seconded with all in favor.

Brad Dwenger moved to approve the same minutes, Aaron Roberts seconded with all in favor.

Gary Callahan requested to transfer \$52.65 from 1000.22120.000.0013 Printed Office Supplies to 1000.33810.000.0013 Dues, Subscriptions, Fees and \$249.74 from 1000.10914.000.0013 Payroll to 1000.10202.000.0013 Chief Deputy. Beth Leisure moved for approval, Cathy Williams seconded with all in favor.

Lonnie McClintock requested to transfer \$464.11 from 1000.33200.000.0660 Contractual Professional and \$302.89 from 1000.22110.000.0660 Office Supplies to 1000.33201.000.0660 Postage for a total of \$767.00. Barry Ritter moved for approval, Gary Saunders seconded with all in favor.

Adam McQueen originally asked council to transfer \$22,000 into fund 4902 IV-D Court, since then the reimbursements from the state have been received and this fund is now in the black. October and November payments are still outstanding, which when received will stabilize the IV-D Court fund, council will wait and see if those payments come in before transferring any money into this account. The IV-D Court fund will be revisited in January.

Mr. McQueen requested to transfer \$5,000 from 1000.33040.000.0200 Pauper Attorney to 1000.33170.000.0200 Criminal Appeals. Jeff Cappa moved for approval of the transfer, Cathy Williams seconded with all in favor.

Mr. McQueen requested to post a clerical position that is open in the probation department. The position is a full-time position and budgeted for 2026. Beth Leisure moved to post and hire for the open probation clerical position, Jeff Cappa seconded with all in favor.

1 Gordon Moore requested to transfer \$1,200 from 1202.13480.000.0000 Part-time 1 to
2 1202.10100.000.0000 Elected Official. Beth Leisure moved for approval, Gary Saunders
3 seconded with all in favor.

4
5 Mr. Moore requested to post a clerical position in his office for his clerical staff that is retiring in
6 January. Barry Ritter moved for approval of the post to hire, Beth Leisure seconded with all in
7 favor.

8
9 Sheriff Retter requested approval of the sheriff's commissary fund resolution 2025-06. This brings
10 the resolution up to date with state statute and the current commissary expenses. Cathy Williams
11 moved for approval of commissary resolution 2025-06, Jeff Cappa seconded with all in favor.

12
13 Sheriff Retter requested to transfer \$2,221.50 from 1000.10915.000.0380 Inmate Sch.
14 Coordinator to 1000.11900.000.0380 Deputy 12 and \$49.96 from 1000.10915.000.0380 Inmate
15 Sch. Coordinator to 1000.12270.000.0380 Correctional Officer 18. Barry Ritter moved for
16 approval, Gary Saunders seconded with all in favor.

17
18 Steve Higinbotham requested to transfer \$2,300 from 1000.13361.000.0806 Payroll to
19 1000.33510.000.0806 Utilities and \$1,000 from 1000.13361.000.0806 Payroll to
20 1000.13640.000.0806 Overtime. Cathy Williams moved for approval, Gary Saunders seconded
21 with all in favor.

22
23 Mr. Higinbotham requested to transfer \$4,304.75 from 1000.13330.000.0313 General
24 Maintenance to 1000.10118.000.0313 Asst. Superintendent. Beth Leisure moved for approval,
25 Barry Ritter seconded with all in favor.

26
27 Matthew Cain requested to create fund 8103 naming it 2026 HMEP and creating line 33200
28 contractual. Jeff Cappa moved for approval, Gary Saunders seconded with all in favor.

29
30 Mr. Cain requested to transfer \$1,769.80 from 1000.13480.000.0301 Comm Specialist to
31 1000.12300.000.0301 Comm Specialist. Gary Saunders moved for approval, Barry Ritter
32 seconded with all in favor.

33
34 Dan Burk requested for council to reappoint Rodger Smith to the health board for another 4-year
35 term. Jeff Cappa moved to reappoint Rodger Smith, Cathy Williams seconded with all in favor.

36
37 Mr. Burk is requesting to reclassify and hire the LPN position to a medical assistant position. This
38 reclassification will not need to go to Irwin as we already have a job description for a medical
39 assistant, this will also lower the salary for this position. Barry Ritter moved to reclassify the open
40 position to a medical assistant and post for hire, Gary Saunders seconded with all in favor.

41
42 There are 4 interlocal agreements ready for council and commissioners' approval for the
43 emergency radio equipment with Fountain City/Northeast Fire Territory, Cambridge City Fire,
44 Perry Township Fire, and a three way agreement with Milton and Washington Township. Gary
45 Saunders moved for approval of the 4 interlocal agreements, Beth Leisure seconded with all in
46 favor. Brad Dwenger moved for approval, Aaron Roberts seconded with all in favor.

47
48 Longevity resolution 2025-05 for 2026 is ready for approval. Jeff Cappa moved for approval, Barry
49 Ritter seconded with all in favor.

50

1 Salary ordinance 2025-03 for 2026 is ready for approval. Gary Saunders moved for approval, Jeff
2 Cappa seconded with all in favor.

3
4 There was a request for the finance committee chairwoman to be able to work with the auditor's
5 office to make adjustments to any line items that may be in the red for end of year clean-up. Cathy
6 Williams moved for approval, Barry Ritter seconded with all in favor.

7
8 Steve Higinbotham gave his project update. Fairgrounds parking lot estimate of cost has come in
9 which includes an upgrade to the drainage. Cathy Williams moved for the council to agree to
10 move forward with the appropriation of funds next year to pay for this project, Jeff Cappa
11 seconded with all in favor.

12
13 The chamber camera system needs to be replaced to be functional and will have 6 cameras that
14 will be controlled by a tricastar which will eliminate the need for the tripod camera. Brad Dwenger
15 moved for approval of the estimate from Wilco subject to the money being appropriated from cum
16 court by council, Aaron Roberts seconded with all in favor.

17
18 The new vault cap for the electrical vault on 4th street should be delivered the first week in January.
19 Once that is in place the plaza work should start back up.

20
21 Barry Ritter gave a financial report on the radio project. The Thermobond contract came in under
22 budget so there is a little extra money to roll back into the project. Other excess ARPA dollars
23 have been transferred into this project as well protecting the contingency dollars in the general
24 fund.

25
26 Jeff Plasterer stated the landbank is making progress toward getting an agreement put together.
27 ARPA funds are budgeted for 2026. There is a plan to conduct a review of the county personnel
28 policy and incorporate the addendums into an updated handbook.

29
30 Aaron Roberts moved to approve the following claims: MasterCard paid December 16th, claims
31 dated December 17th, federal payroll tax and retirement, payroll, and Dunn flex, dental, STD, VTL
32 only, and garnishments all dated December 12th, Brad Dwenger seconded with all in favor.

33
34 With no further business, Barry Ritter motioned to adjourn, seconded by Cathy Williams and the
35 meeting adjourned at 6:56 PM. Next meeting is January 7, 2026 at 8:00 AM, next workshop is
36 January 21, 2026 at 6:00 PM.

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43 _____
44 Max Smith, President of County Council

Jeffrey C. Plasterer, Pres. of Bd. of Comm

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47 _____
48 Mark Hoelscher, Auditor